

Peaceful & Restorative Sleep

Myth Busting

- Sleep is not a luxury but a necessity for prolonged peak performance. Why else would Roger Federer be sleeping 10-hours per night and playing top level tennis at 37.
- Luckily for us as we may not have the lifestyle where 10-hours sleep is possible there are also ways to improve our sleep quality which will enable us to perform better and feel more energised.
- If you suffer from a chronic lack of sleep the research shows that we actually stop recognising the negative impact which it has on performance.

Useful Thought Experiments

- Do you need an alarm to wake you? Do you fall asleep in front of the TV? Does a low dose of alcohol make you feel drowsy? Does a warm room make you sleepy? Do you feel like nodding off in a boring meeting?
- The more you answer yes, the more sleep deprived you are.
- The last time you were on holiday can you remember how long you slept each night? This is a good indicator as to your ideal sleep length. If you can't remember then trial this on your next holiday but remember to use the second night's sleep length as your barometer as the first night is often a 'catch up' sleep.

Important New Outlook

- Improving your quantity and quality of sleep begins a lot earlier in the day than most of us recognise. Simple decisions like trying to move more, eat better and access sunlight all have a significant role to play. Other decisions like leaving the office on time by not sending those three non-essential emails can help you to create time to get to bed earlier.
- Audit your evening with the additional resource to see where your time sinks are that stop you getting to bed earlier e.g. you might notice that you spend 30-minutes perusing your Facebook newsfeed unnecessarily every evening and this can be eliminated.

Sleep Cave & Runway

- Have you taken action to ensure where you sleep is dark, cool, quiet, clean and cosy? This will help with sleep quality. Investments which you can make from cheaper to more expensive are: ear plugs, face mask, white noise machine, comfy linens and Pjs, black out blinds, sound proof windows etc.
- You can also look to get that room temperature around 18C for optimal sleep.
- Try and make the last hour before bed something you look forward to by incorporating pleasurable things like scent (candles or diffuser), reading, stretching or deep breathing.

